

The STANDARD

*To Know Him
And
To Make Him Known*

July 1993

STILL STANDING!

Billy Bevan, President

When it comes right down to it, no one really likes controversy! At age forty-five, I can assure you that I don't like it in my church, at our college, or in my denomination! I would rather everything run smoothly and for there to be no "ripples on the pond;" alas, no need for negativism and confrontation.

In all honesty, however, that is probably being a bit idealistic. Life just doesn't seem to turn out that way.

The very history of Christianity and Free Will Baptists has had its beginnings in controversy and confrontation.

I have always felt that our faith was to be a "militant" faith! We are to be aggressive and not passive in what we believe and propagate. Yes, be Christian about it, but at the same time be willing to stand for what is right, even in the face of controversy!

Christianity, Free Will Baptists, and conservative fundamentalism has not gotten to where we are with the "peace at any price" mentality.

Someone has said, "if you don't stand for something, you will fall for anything." When issues are at stake and questions need to be answered, we must stand, yea, it is out duty to do so.

I am troubled by a contingency in our Free Will Baptists ranks that automatically labels an individual who raises a question as a "trouble-maker." I think it is very unfair and absolutely judgmental. While it may be true (I do not know if it is) that some who constantly raise questions and seem difficult to be satisfied may have a secret agenda, I believe it is possible to take a stand and ask questions out of a heart that is motivated by righteousness and truth. An individual with such motives should not be castigated by those who wish he would keep quiet.

I admit I am a very opinionated person and so are most of my friends. (Boy, you should be in on some of our discussions--excuse me, arguments). But the truth is, so is everyone reading this article. All of us like our opinions better than we like others' opinions. I may not always be right, but it is not wrong

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for me to stand for what I strongly believe. I have always admired a fellow for standing for what he believes, even if I don't always agree with him.

I don't like to be talked about unkindly, but if taking a stand for what I believe brings the criticism of others, so be it. I want to be found "still standing."

Where are you standing? What do you believe? Do you feel strongly about anything?

I started to say it is confusing, but probably more appropriate is the word alarming, at the uncertain sounds that are being heard within

the ranks of Free Will Baptists.

All of us get tired of fighting! I get tired of fighting the battles in my church, at the college, and yes, in my denomination. But we should not get too tired to keep standing and fighting for what is right.

Recently I read a quotation from Bishop J. C. Ryles. He said, "Controversy in religion is a hateful thing. It is hard enough to fight the Devil, the world, and the flesh, without private differences in our own camp. But there is one thing which is even worse than controversy, and that is false doctrine tolerated, allowed, and permitted without protest or molestation." Amen! (that is an excellent statement).



While, as far as I know, we don't have false doctrine among us, I simply ask you, "How is it we can make such a statement?" Because of our stand in the past for righteousness! If we do not continue to stand on issues in light of Scripture, we will not be able to make that statement in the future! I am glad we say we have no liberals among us, but you can be "liberal toward liberals" and such a trend is troubling.

In recent days, I have made up my mind to be "still standing" on such issues as the inerrancy of the Scriptures, the deity of Christ, salvation by faith alone, the literalness of hell, soul winning, missions, Christian schools, the bus ministry, the local church, the pastor as a leader, modesty for men and women, movies, mixed swimming, rock music, long hair on men, petting and premarital sex, drinking

of alcoholic beverages, etc. I'm still standing where I stood twenty-three years ago when I started as a Free Will Baptist pastor.

I do not agree with the argument that Christian maturity changes your beliefs. It may change your "disposition" but not your "position."

I fully understand the cry for peace and harmony and I hope as much as anyone that we can have it. However, James 3:17a says, "But the wisdom that is from above is first pure, then peaceable,..." As much as it is possible, we are to live peaceably with all men. All of us

agree and would welcome that scenario. There comes a time, however, when something takes precedence over personal relationships and that

is standing for what is "right."

May we do our best to demonstrate the spirit of Christ and when He comes may He find each of us "still standing."

IMPORTANT DATES TO REMEMBER

August
18-20 *Student Leadership Conference*
21 *Freshmen Arrive*
23-24 *Freshmen Orientation*
23.. *Dorms Open for All Other Students*
24 *Registration*
25 *Classes Begin*

October
21-22 *Missions Conference*

November
4-6 *Get Acquainted Days*

GOOD-BYES ARE TOUGH

With regret, we say good-bye to two faithful staff members: Myrna Simpkins (bookkeeping) and Sonya Cheney (secretary). The Simpkins family is moving back to Tennessee and Sonya is getting married in August.

Both have been great assets to the ministry of the college and went the second mile in service and sacrifice. They will be greatly missed.

*Missionary
Conference
dates have
been
changed.*

Missions Update!!

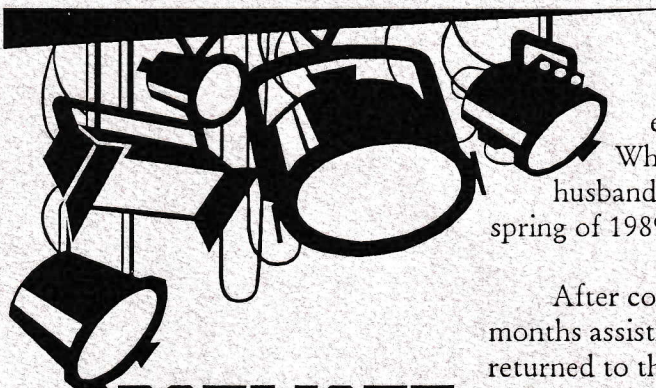
October 21-22, 1993

come and hear
Dr.M.A. Thomas
founder of Christ for India,
the Howard Guartney
Family, Home Missionaries
to Pheonix Arizona,
Alumnus, Hament Patel,
and Prof. Danny Baer.

ADDITIONAL GIFTS RECEIVED TOWARD OUR TENTH ANNIVERSARY

"Our Special Thanks to You"

Rev. and Mrs. Phil Ange, SC
Mr. & Mrs. A. B. Brown, NC
Mr. & Mrs. James W. Hensley, TN
Ms. Margaret W. Macon, NC
Mr. & Mrs. Linwood R. Morris, NC
Mr. & Mrs. John M. Locklear, NC
Mrs. Marjorie Noel, TN
Ms. Evelyn Owens, NC
Mr. & Mrs. Timothy D. Rabon, NC
Rev. & Mrs. Elmer Turnbough, NC
Mr. James Ward, NC
Mr. & Mrs. Robert Worthington, NC



SPOTLIGHT ON

ALUMNI

Bobbie Ann (Sanford) Rodriguez graduated from Southeastern in 1988 with a Bachelor Degree in Christian Education. While attending Southeastern, Bobbie Ann dated her future husband Mike, who graduated with a Bachelor Degree in Bible in the spring of 1989.

After completing their studies at Southeastern, they spent several months assisting with the mission work in Rennes, France. When they returned to the states, Mike became the youth pastor working with Rev. Richard Atwood in Townsend, Delaware. While there, Bobbie Ann taught the teen Sunday School class. Since January 1, 1993, Mike has been Youth and Bus Minister at the First Free Will Baptist Church, Florence, Alabama, where Bobbie Ann teaches the teen Sunday School class.

They have two children, Sanford and Michaelann.

JULY TRAVEL SCHEDULE FOR THE *SOUNDS OF PRAISE* ENSEMBLE

July 1
Waldorf FWB Church,
Waldorf, MD
Pastor Frank Owens

July 3-4
Free Will Baptist Church,
New Castle, DE
Pastor Jay Baines

July 6
Townsend FWB Mission,
Townsend, DE
Pastor Richard Atwood

July 7
Mt. Calvary FWB Church,
Perryman, MD
Pastor Bob Trimble

July 8
Yorkshire FWB Church,
Manassas, VA
Pastor Lonnie Salyers

July 9-11
First FWB Church,
Wheeling, WV
Pastor J. D. McCormick

July 11 p.m.
Williams Road FWB Church,
Columbus, OH
Pastor James Blair

July 13
Canaanland FWB Church,
Grove City, OH
Pastor Lovell May

July 14
Wyandotte FWB Church,
Mansfield, OH
Pastor Hertis Stone

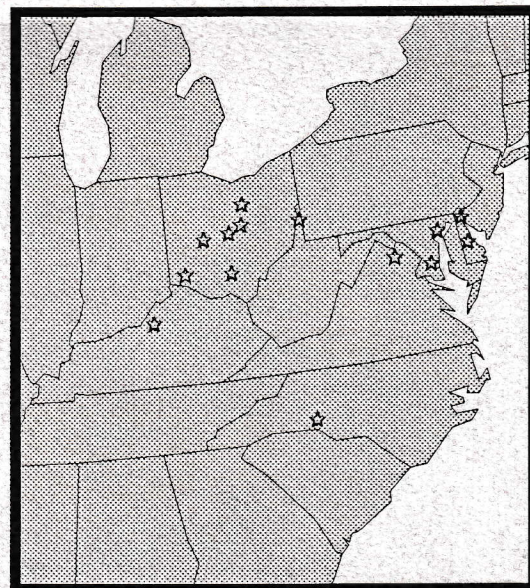
July 15
Forest Valley FWB Church,
Springfield, OH
Pastor Robert Mead

July 17
Dailyville FWB Church,
Waverly, OH
Pastor Carl Dunn

July 18 a.m.
Ambassador FWB Church, Cincinnati, OH
Pastor Roland Luthy

July 18 p.m.-22
National Association of FWB,
Louisville, KY

July 23
First FWB Church,
Gastonia, NC
Pastor William Calvert



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Southeastern
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Congratulations, Graduates!!

Southeastern Free Will Baptist College's tenth graduation service was held May 13 at First FWB Church, Raleigh, NC. Rev. Van Dale Hudson of Amory, Mississippi delivered the graduation message to the eighteen graduates, their families, and their friends.

The graduation service in-

cluded a few special presentations.

The college yearbook's "Pastor Tribute" was presented to Dr. Lorenza Stox, pastor of the Parker's Chapel FWB Church in Greenville, NC, for his many years of hard work and dedication to Southeastern. Myrna Simpkins and Sonya Cheney, who are leaving their positions at Southeastern, were also honored for their service to the college.

Matt Petit from Newport News VA was this year's recipient of the most outstanding student award. The Christian Service award went to Christian Powell from Raleigh, NC and the sports trophy was presented to the Delta Kappa and Susannah Wesley Societies.



Bachelor Degree in Bible

*Norman David Austin
Tony Allen Hall, Jr.
Ronald Dwayne James*



Bachelor Degree in Biblical Studies

*Devin Paul Hudson
Kenneth R. Lane
Matthew Loren Pettit
Michael Christian Powell*



Bachelor Degree in Christian Education

*Sonya Elaine Dodgens
Shannon Michelle Durn
Pamela Gayle Farley
Gary Thomas Goodfellow, Jr.
Melissa Jane Muse
Mitzi Michelle Wright*



Christian School of Business Diploma

*Starla May Hudson
Candace Marie Newcomb
Tracy H. Price
Amelia Jo Stewart
Angela Dawn Williams*